

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on :

PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS

**Bethel Global Missions
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OUR THEME: LAUGHING AT THE FUTURE - WITHOUT FEAR

*Strength and dignity are her clothing.
She laughs at the time to come.*

Proverbs 31:25 WEB

*Proverbs 31:25 She is clothed with **strength and dignity**, and she laughs **WITHOUT FEAR** of the future. NLT*

*Proverbs 31:25 She is **clothed** with strength and dignity; she can laugh at the days to come. NIV*

*Proverbs 31:25 She is a woman of **strength** and **dignity** and has no fear of old age. TLB*

I AM SURE THAT MOST OF US ARE AWARE OF THE MANY PEOPLE IN OUR PRESENT WORLD WHO ARE APPREHENSIVE AND FEARFUL OF THE FUTURE. MARRIED COUPLES ARE EVEN EXPRESSING THEIR RELUCTANCE TO HAVE CHILDREN BECAUSE OF THE UNCERTAINTY OF THE FUTURE OF THE WORLD. OTHERS HAVE ALL KINDS OF CONSPIRACIES, INTRIGUES THAT SEEMS TO REINFORCE THE INWARD FEAR OF THE FUTURE.

- IN THIS PASSAGE FROM THE BIBLE WE HAVE A WOMAN WHO AMAZINGLY WAS ABLE TO **LAUGH AT THE FUTURE – AND TO LAUGH WITHOUT FEAR.**
- **THIS WAS NOT THE LAUGH OF RIDICULE, FOLLY, OR SCEPTICISM BUT THE LAUGH OF FAITH.**
- * **A FAITH** THAT WAS FOUNDED ON SOMETHING THAT ENABLED HER LAUGH WITH POSITIVENESS AND PURPOSEFUL EXPECTATION OF THE FUTURE.
- * SUBSTANTIAL FOUNDATION FOR FAITH THAT EMPOWERED HER TO LAUGH WITHOUT THE SENSE OF FEAR.
- * THAT FOUNDATION WAS MOST LIKELY TO RELATED TO THE STRENGTH AND DIGNITY THAT CLOTHED HER LIFE.

THERE ARE THREE THINGS WE CAN DEVELOP AND DEFINE.

1. **THE LAUGH OF FAITH**
2. **THE MEANING OF BEING CLOTHED**
3. **THE MEANING OF STRENGTH, DIGNITY AND HONOUR**

"She is clothed with strength and dignity, and she laughs without fear of the future."

EXAMPLES OF PEOPLE WHO LAUGHED IN THE BIBLE

- **ABRAHAM LAUGHED at God's promise.**
- * **IT WAS THE LAUGH OF GREAT JOY. ABRAHAM'S LAUGHTER WAS A LAUGHTER OF DELIGHT, NOT OF DISTRUST.**
- * **ABRAHAM FELL ON HIS FACE SHOWING HUMILITY. HE WAS OVERWHELMED WITH GRACIOUSNESS AND UNDESERVING ACT TOWARDS HIM.**

Genesis 17:15-17

15 God also said to Abraham, "As for Sarai your wife, you are no longer to call her Sarai; her name will be Sarah.

16 I will bless her and will surely give you a son by her. I will bless her so that she will be the mother of nations; kings of peoples will come from her."

17 Abraham fell facedown; he laughed and said to himself, "Will a son be born to a man a hundred years old? Will Sarah bear a child at the age of ninety?" NIV

■ SARAH LAUGHED IN UNBELIEF – BUT ABRAHAM LAUGHED IN WONDER

Genesis 18:12-15

12 So Sarah laughed to herself as she thought, "After I am worn out and my master is old, will I now have this pleasure?"

13 Then the Lord said to Abraham, "Why did Sarah laugh and say, 'Will I really have a child, now that I am old?'"

14 Is anything too hard for the Lord? I will return to you at the appointed time next year and Sarah will have a son."

15 Sarah was afraid, so she lied and said, "I did not laugh." But he said, "Yes, you did laugh." NIV

■ GOD FINALLY BROUGHT SARAH TO LAUGHTER – THE LAUGH OF AMAZEMENT AND FULFILMENT OF THE IMPOSSIBLE.

Genesis 21:5-7

5 Abraham was a hundred years old when his son Isaac was born to him. - 6 Sarah said, "God has brought me laughter, and everyone who hears about this will laugh with me." - 7 And she added, "Who would have said to Abraham that Sarah would nurse children? Yet I have borne him a son in his old age." NIV

■ THE LAUGH OF SCORN, RIDICULE / MOCKING

Jesus faced this from the crowd.

Matthew 9:24 He said unto them, Give place: for the maid is not dead, but sleepeth. And **they laughed him to scorn.** KJV

Matthew 9:24-25

"You must all go outside; the little girl is not dead; she is fast asleep." - 26 "This was met with **scornful laughter**". J.B. PHILLIPS (Luke 8:53 Mark 5:40)

■ CLOTHED its meaning.

* Faithful to God, God-fearing, and **CLOTHED with INNER BEAUTY**, (Proverbs 31, 25,26, Proverbs 31,30) in describing the ideal woman's **BEAUTY**, verse 25 speaks of **her spiritual dress** by telling us that; "she is clothed with strength and dignity, she can laugh at the days to come.

* The Bible explains the meaning of "**clothed**" primarily as the endowment of power "**from on high**".

Luke 24:49 And behold, I will send forth upon you what My Father has promised; but remain in the city [Jerusalem] until you are clothed with power from on high. AMP

■ CLOTHED WITH STRENGTH AND DIGNITY.

* The **BEAUTY** of Proverbs 31:25 is in its **SIMPLICITY**.

* The woman described here is **clothed with strength and dignity**, which implies an **inner strength and confidence** that comes from living a life of **INTEGRITY**.

■ STRENGTH and DIGNITY

* To face those days and events that are in **THE FUTURE** – including the **SECOND COMING** of Jesus Christ to this earth INCLUDING **OLD AGE**.

Proverbs 31:25 She is clothed with strength and dignity, and she laughs **WITHOUT FEAR** of the future. NLT

Proverbs 31:25 **Strength and honor ARE HER CLOTHING**, and **she can laugh at the time to come.** Holman

■ BEING ABLE TO LAUGH AT THE FUTURE

* **WE CAN DO THIS BECAUSE THE GOD WHO DETERMINES THE PRESENT ALSO HOLDS THE FUTURE.**

Psalms 103:19 The Lord has established his throne in the heavens, and his kingdom rules overall. ESV (Psalms 66:7 NIV)

Daniel 4:17. "... the Most High is sovereign over the kingdoms of men and gives them to anyone he wishes NIV - (Daniel 5:21 Daniel 4:25)

■ LIVING A LIFE FREE FROM FEAR OF THE PAST & THE FUTURE.

* **LIVING WITH THAT CONFIDENCE THAT COMES FROM THE BELIEVER SEEKING TO DEVELOP & GROW THOSE INNER QUALITIES OF BEAUTY (GODLINESS) DIGNITY AND WORTH THAT EMPOWERS WITH STRENGTH AND REMOVES FEAR.**

* **MAKING THOSE QUALITIES TO BE AN INTEGRAL PART OF OUR LIVES SO THAT IT WAS AS IF WE WERE "CLOTHED" WITH THEM.**

* **THIS CONFIDENCE STEMS FROM HAVING BEEN JUSTIFIED AND BROUGHT INTO RIGHT STANDING WITH GOD – Amen Ps Barry**